Principal user manual

School Marks Analytics

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School Marks Analytics — guide for the Principal role.

The principal owns school setup, staff access, leave and cover, mark approval, leadership analytics, and board-facing outputs. Principals do not type or bulk-upload marks; teachers and exam co-ordinators enter registers, and you review and approve them.

1. Sign in and home desk

- Open the app login page (/login). If your school is on an invite-led pilot, use the principal email and temporary password from PencilLabs / the platform operator — you will be asked to change the password on first sign-in.
- Enter your email, school ID, and password.
- If MFA is enabled, enter the 6-digit authenticator code (or a recovery code).

  You land on the Principal desk (/): an ops-first view with approvals, Needs attention / notify, and Exam queue shortcuts. School averages and the Curricular Performance Hub live under School snapshot (collapsed when work is waiting). Use Deep insights and Consolidated lists from the hero actions.
- Use the exam selector at the top to switch the working exam. Teachers and leadership share the same latest exam by default.
- Open the ? hint on any page for a short “what’s on this page” tip (and How it is useful).
- Download this guide any time from HELP !’ User manuals.

2. First-time school setup

Work through these once per academic year (and whenever structure changes).

2.1 School profile (School setup !’ School profile)

The page is split into tabs. Jump to the section you need:

Tab	What to do
Identity & Affiliation	School name, short name, board, affiliation, motto, crest. Upload a PNG or JPEG logo — it prints as letterhead on report cards, class summaries, consolidated lists, and Excel downloads.
Campus & Contact	Address, phone, email, website, and other campus details.
Modules & Security	Staff join code (share with teachers and co-ordinators so they can request access at /signup). Only the principal can rotate the join code. Optionally enable email digests and optional modules (Show Board ops, Show CPD). Staff still need the matching permission under Staff !’ Role access.
Grading Framework	Pass percent, distinction minimum, grade bands, and unit / mid / final weights for the annual composite used in Deep insights. Configure these before publishing results.
Bell Schedule & Timings	Working week (5 or 6 days) and bell schedule (period names and times) so timetables match your day. Deep-link #school-schedule opens this tab.

2.2 Records (School setup !’ Records)

Tab	What to do

Classes	Create a class with several divisions at once (Add class with divisions, Fill A–D for a quick start); assign a class teacher per division. The drop-down labels teachers who are already class teacher of another section. The Registered class sections directory expands a grade to manage divisions — search by class, section, or teacher; filter by class teacher / status; export CSV.
Subjects	Add subjects to the pool with Max marks (theory ceiling for mark entry). Optional Practical max (leave blank for theory-only). Tick Elective (enroll selected students only) and use Enrollments to pick students. Then select which pool subjects each class uses.
Students	Add or import the roll; upload photos for hall tickets (or use Marks !' Student photos).
Exams	Create exams; under Classes in this exam choose which classes sit under it (Select all / Clear, or toggle Class {name} — editable later). Set paper dates (same date for all, or per class/subject); set Max marks [consolidation]; Lock for consolidation when ready. If one class paper timetable is complete, Copy class timetable to all classes.
Promote	After a year, promote a class to the next section without losing prior marks.

2.3 Staff (School setup !' Staff)

- Activate pending sign-ups, or add / bulk-import staff (Name, Email, School ID, Password, Role).
- The list is an accordion: expand a row for assignments and actions (edit, Transfer classes, timetable, notify).
- Only the principal can create exam co-ordinator accounts and open Role access.
- Under Role access, grant menu features per role — including Timetables, Leave approval, and Assign substitutes for vice principals, supervisors, or co-ordinators.
- Assign class + subject papers to any staff role — including principal, vice principal, and co-ordinators — as well as teachers. Teachers cannot enter marks until they are ACTIVE and assigned.
- Open a teacher's timetable from the staff row when needed.

2.4 Timetables (School setup !' Timetables)

Four tabs: Teachers, Daily board, Find free, Leave & cover. Tabs appear according to Role access (Timetables, Leave approval, Assign substitutes).

Teachers (accordion)

- Search teachers, or filter by class and subject. Each row shows subjects and a periods/week badge.
- Expand a teacher, then:
- Open timetable — embedded weekly grid, plus Open full page for Daily / Weekly / Hours history (leadership can add or remove periods on the full page).
- Put on leave — Start / End, optional reason. If you can assign substitutes, tick Suggest a different free teacher for each vacated period. Save leave, then Review covers.
- Hrs history — own teaching hours plus extra cover hours. The week follows the working days in School profile (not Monday–Sunday). Use Previous week / Next week, or From / To and Show range (up to 31 days).

Daily board

- One page with every teacher for a chosen day. Summary: on leave · need cover · covers assigned.
- Green cells are free. Click and drag to scroll periods.
- Each teacher row shows period count and teaching hours, plus +extra hours when they are covering.
- Vacated cells show Needs cover, Cover, or On leave · covered. Use Assign cover on an uncovered cell to pick a ranked substitute (Score, free periods left).

- Put on leave from a teacher row when Leave approval is enabled.

  Find free

- Pick a date and Period. Sections: Free teachers, On leave, Teaching this period (includes Cover rows).

  Leave & cover

- Pending leave requests — teachers submit My leave on their dashboard. Approve (overlays timetables and notifies principal, vice principal, supervisors, and co-ordinators) or Reject.
- Put a teacher on leave — same form as the accordion; can auto-suggest covers.
- Cover planner — accept ranked substitutes per vacated period (Accept selected covers). Slots that cannot be auto-suggested stay on the daily board as Needs cover.

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3. Exam cycle — marks workflow

`Teachers enter drafts !’ Submit !’ Leadership Approve !’ Analytics & CML include marks`

3.1 Exam queue (Today !’ Exam queue)

One hub for exam week:

Tab	Job
Missing	Chase teachers who still have empty registers (Mark progress). Notify and open registers.
Submitted	Approve submitted registers waiting on leadership.
Access requests	Late-entry and edit requests.
Ready for CML	Open consolidated mark lists (CML) when papers are approved.

- Select the exam on the Missing tab.
- Expand a teacher for papers, Notify, Open register, and Approve on Submitted.
- Notify teachers (deadline, incomplete marklist, or custom message) for everyone still missing marks, or one teacher.
- Open a register !’ Approve submitted marks. Only approved marks feed school analytics, ranks, and consolidated lists.
- Use Moderate on the register for grace adjustments with a reason (stays approved and audited).

When you open a register, split papers show Theory max and Practical max (codes AB / EX / WH apply to theory only). Elective papers show a dash for students who are not enrolled.

Principals open registers from Exam queue (there is no Mark register / Bulk upload item in the principal sidebar). Bookmarks to /pending-uploads or /approvals redirect into the matching Exam queue tab.

3.2 Access requests (Exam queue !’ Access requests)

Teachers may ask for late entry after a deadline or to edit a submitted register. Approve only when a genuine correction is needed — every grant is recorded on the audit log.

3.3 Special mark codes

On registers, staff may enter:

Code	Meaning
AB	Absent
EX	Exempt
WH	Withheld

On theory + practical papers these codes apply to theory only.

3.4 Consolidated lists (Marks !’ Consolidated lists)

- Ensure Max marks (Subjects) and consolidation max (Exams) are set and locked as needed. Lists scale entry marks onto the consolidation ceiling.
- Choose exam !’ class !’ division.
- Divisions show Ready when every subject register is fully approved.
- Download Excel or PDF. Incomplete divisions can be downloaded as a preview (watermarked). Official download requires full approval.
- From an incomplete class, notify the teachers still missing papers.

3.5 Hall tickets (Marks !’ Hall tickets)

- Pick exam, class, and division.
- Create/edit batch details (title, venue, instructions). Tick Print student photos when available.
- Preview on the right (With photo count); Download PDF (5 / A4) (or the PDF button beside each division).
- Paper dates and start times must exist under Records !’ Exams for every class that needs tickets (or fill one class and use Copy class timetable to all classes).

  Upload photos under Marks !’ Student photos (or Records !’ Students). Use Bulk upload by admission no with files named like ADM-10B-01.jpg, or add one photo per student. PNG or JPEG, 1 MB or smaller. Unmatched files can be removed with Remove unmatched.

3.6 Audit log (Marks !’ Audit log)

Principals can filter by role and actor and see mark changes, approvals, and access grants — including exam-co-ordinator actions.

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4. Insights and analysis

Open Insights !’ Marks analysis (or cards on the hub):

Report	Use it to…
School overview	KPIs, grade mix, toppers, year-on-year movement
Classes	Compare classes/sections; drill into a division
Subjects	Hard papers, class splits, teacher-to-teacher comparison
Teachers	Averages, register status, peer comparison
Students	Search a student; trends, strengths, report card
Compare	Previous years; same-subject across teachers
Deep insights	Outcomes/bands, exam readiness, division gaps, improvement cohorts, promotion carry-forward, teacher load, weighted annuals

Deep insights panels each have their own hint icon explaining the measure and how to act on it.

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5. Board ops and CPD (optional modules)

Enable under School profile !’ Modules & Security if your school uses them, then grant the matching Role access.

Board ops (School setup !’ Board ops)

Per-paper calendar and venues, report-card publish and principal sign-off, parent notify, revaluation workflow, and downloadable board packs.

CPD (School setup !’ CPD)

Training plans, lesson observations, appraisals, and certificates. Leadership can open any teacher’s CPD file.

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6. Parent / student portal

From Records (students / exam context), leadership can issue a portal link for a student and exam. Parents open /portal with that link to see approved marks for that exam only.

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7. Notify teachers

Send in-app notices from:

- Exam queue / Mark progress / dashboards (pending or one teacher)
- Consolidated lists (incomplete class)
- Records !’ Exams (deadline reminder)
- Staff (one teacher or all)

Teachers see notices in the bell and on their dashboard, with links into the relevant register.

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8. Your profile

Under Account !’ Profile: update name/email details, change password, and enable MFA (TOTP). Keep recovery codes safe.

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9. Typical principal checklist (per exam)

- Confirm subjects (including practical max / electives), max marks, roll, photos, included classes, and paper dates in Records.
- Lock consolidation max marks when ready.
- Confirm teacher assignments, Role access (leave / substitutes), and deadlines.
- Clear Exam queue — notify on Missing, then Approve on Submitted.
- Resolve Access requests only when needed.
- Approve Pending leave requests and assign cover so the daily board stays current.
- Review Deep insights !’ Exam readiness, then school/class/subject reports.
- Generate official consolidated lists and hall tickets (Download PDF (5 / A4)).
- Publish / sign off report cards (Board ops) if used.
- Spot-check the Audit log if any result is questioned.

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10. Principal-only capabilities

Compared with the exam co-ordinator, only the principal can:

- Create and manage exam co-ordinator accounts
- Manage staff Role access (including Timetables, Leave approval, Assign substitutes)
- Rotate the school join code
- Toggle optional modules (Board ops / CPD) when saving school profile
- View the full audit trail (including co-ordinator actions)

Principals do not enter or bulk-upload mark registers.